

20-Year Coaching Review Report: Markus Schmidberger (2006–2026)

1. Executive Summary

This formal report documents the twenty-year professional and personal leadership evolution of Markus Schmidberger from 2006 to 2026. Over two decades of executive coaching and consulting, Markus transitioned from an academic professional challenged by rigid workplace expectations into a highly self-aware executive, data organization leader, and certified coach.

The core arc of his transformation encompasses four fundamental pillars:

1. **Boundary Assertion & Personal Agency:** Moving from unwritten workplace compliance to establishing clear contractual boundaries while delivering high performance.
2. **Emotional Digestion & Reactive Self-Regulation:** Replacing stress-induced shutdowns (despair, panic, shock) with active internal emotional digestion using Parts Work and somatic tools.
3. **Enhanced Agile Leadership & Team Scaling:** Scaling technology and data organizations from 5 to 50 people by combining Scrum frameworks with psychological safety, non-punitive error analysis, and crisis regulation.
4. **Deconstruction of Unconscious Beliefs:** Shifting away from childhood-inherited "rule-based living" to flexible "him-based living," taking full responsibility for his personal and professional thriving.

Currently operating as a co-founder of a coaching firm, CTO, and certified practitioner, Markus is transitioning back into corporate executive leadership while maintaining a peer-level consulting relationship with his coach.

2. Comprehensive Phase-by-Phase Timeline (2006–2026)

Phase 1: Boundary Setting & Baseline Autonomy (2006–2011)

- **2006:**
Completes his Diploma in Technical Mathematics.
Begins his first post-university position at an academic chair.
When cornered in his professor's office by two senior colleagues pressuring him to donate 20 unpaid personal hours per week to PhD work on top of his 40 contractual chair hours, Markus is already prepared (using three structured reflection questions *"What do you want?"*, *"What are you prepared to give for this?"*, *"What are you prepared to do if your boundaries are not respected at this workplace?"*). He asserts his legal boundaries, demonstrates complete competence within contractual hours, and satisfies his professor.
- **2009:**
Completes his PhD in Bioinformatics and welcomes his first son.

- **Jan 2010 – May 2011:**
Works as a Post-doc at the Rost Lab (Computational Biology) at TU Munich.
- **May 2011:**
Leaves academia to join startup CloudNumbers.com as Senior Community Manager, successfully negotiating a **16-hour work week paired with a high salary**.
Simultaneously begins consulting as a Cloud & HPC Consultant for Michael Bailey Associates (~3 years). Welcomes his second son in late 2011.

Phase 2: Interpersonal Friction & Core Emotional Grounding (2011–2014)

- **2011–2013:**
Experiences inner turmoil, insecurity, and relationship strain from balancing modern fatherhood, marriage care, and career shifts. Undertakes two separate 6-month marriage counseling journeys focused on communication, resolving misunderstandings, and clarifying mutual expectations.
- **Oct 2012 – May 2014:**
Serves as Big Data Analyst & Cloud Engineer at Consisto GmbH in Munich.

Phase 3: Enhanced Agile Leadership & Team Scaling (2014–2020)

- **2014:**
Resumes executive coaching focused on "enhanced" agile project management and earns his Scrum Master certification.
- **Jun 2014 – Dec 2015:**
Serves as Senior Big Data Consultant for Professional Services at Amazon Web Services (AWS).
- **2014–2018:**
Immerses in deep personal development methodologies, including *Radikale Erlaubnis* retreats, *Radical Honesty* retreats, analytical psychology, kinesiology, adult and parent Non-Violent Communication (NVC), Internal Family Systems (IFS), *Familienaufstellung*, and mindfulness.
- **Jan 2016 – Apr 2016:**
Serves as Architect Data Platform at ProSiebenSat.1 Digital GmbH.
- **Apr 2016 – Jan 2017:**
Holds the role of Director & Architect Data Platform at Glomex GmbH following an acquisition.
- **Mar 2016 – 2018:**
Launches a side project with his wife titled *Chief Data Officer Business School*.
- **Sep 2017 – Jul 2022:**
Serves as **Director of Data at Scout24 Group**.
Scales his organization from 15 to 45/50 people across companies using enhanced Scrum frameworks rooted in psychological safety, pre-communication emotional reflection, and non-punitive mistake analysis. Successfully reduces employee sick days, prevents crisis-induced "tunnel vision," and elevates overall performance and engagement.

Phase 4: Self-Mastery, Dual Credentials & Peer Autonomy (2021–2026)

- **2021:**
Realizes that managerial reactivity stems from internal fear triggers and moves the coaching relationship into a consulting partnership. Completes his formal **Veit Lindau Coaching Certification**, a 3 month program to address deep-rooted unconscious beliefs and a 6-week positive psychology training program for coaches.
- **2022–2025:**
Operates in an entrepreneurial phase as Co-founder of **Turtle Transformation Ltd.** (a coaching firm with his wife), Co-founder & CTO of **Juntway AI**, Organizer of **TEDx Glenbeigh**, and CTO/Co-founder of **Professional Profile Analytics** (project completed August 2025).
- **2026:**
Transitions from entrepreneurship back into corporate employee leadership, actively interviewing for high-growth executive/CTO roles. Operates in a **collegial peer consulting setup** with his coach, utilizing sessions for high-level self-reflection across career, parenthood, and life.

3. Mastered Tools & Methodologies Playbook

Intervention / Methodology, Primary Purpose & Context, Client Response & Application, Specific Outcome & Leadership Impact

Intervention	Application Context	Breakthrough Outcome
Structured Reflection Questions	Workplace boundary assertion when cornered by senior academics. Prepared responses upfront to 3 core questions regarding wants, gives, and fallback actions.	Asserted legal work hours, satisfied his professor, and gained foundational agency.
Marriage Counseling (Two 6-Month Programs)	Navigating inner turmoil from fatherhood and career shifts. Engaged in joint counseling journeys centered on communication dynamics.	Resolved persistent misunderstandings and aligned expectations between spouses.
Enhanced Agile / Scrum Master	Leadership of growing teams while understanding subconscious triggers. Earned Scrum Master certification; used coaching as a pre-communication reflection space.	Scaled teams from 5 to 50 people, prevented crisis "tunnel vision," reduced sick days, and boosted output.
Radikale Erlaubnis (Mike Hellwig)	Learning to stay present with uncomfortable internal emotions and physical sensations. Attended two live immersion retreats hosted by Mike Hellwig.	Served as a foundational "door opener" to inner emotional presence without reactivity.

Intervention	Application Context	Breakthrough Outcome
Radical Honesty (Brad Blanton)	Overcoming fear of negative reactions and withholding honest opinions. Completed an intensive 5-day Radical Honesty immersion retreat.	Built comfort with open communication and eliminated withholding behaviors driven by fear.
Analytical Psychology	Weekly exploration into potential childhood trauma over 1.5 years. Attended weekly sessions; therapist incorrectly shifted focus onto client's wife.	Proved unhelpful; termination was evaluated and resolved inside executive coaching sessions.
Kinesiology	Clearing stored somatic and subconscious blockages. Worked directly with a practitioner.	Successfully released stored physical and emotional blockages.
Non-Violent Communication (NVC)	Adult, parental, and inter-relational communication. Trained deeply alongside his wife.	Advanced empathetic dialogue skills, reaching levels beyond the standard baseline trainer limits.
Key to the Heart (Safi Nidhaye)	Emotional digestion of severe triggers (despair, panic, shock). Facilitated directly within executive coaching sessions and additional sessions with specialist coach.	Delivered a major breakthrough by preventing emotional shutdowns during severe stress.
Internal Family Systems (IFS)	Addressing deep reactivity triggers that could prompt physical/emotional violence. Facilitated by an external specialist coach.	Enabled safe emotional digestion of extreme reactivity triggers without shutting down.
Familienaufstellung	Exploring generational patterns and parental dynamics (2014–2018). Participated in systemic family constellation sessions.	Gained clarity and perspective regarding his relational history with his parents.
Mindfulness Practice	Building baseline presence and internal awareness. Deep, continuous personal immersion.	Elevated overall presence, groundedness, and emotional stability across roles.
Veit Lindau Coaching & Positive Psychology	Dismantling deep-rooted unconscious beliefs and childhood rules. Completed formal certification and 6-week positive psychology training.	Shifted from rigid "rule-based living" to flexible "him-based living" and solidified self-worth.

4. Synthesis of Resolved Open Questions

1. **Dismantling Childhood Rules:** Shifting from "rule-based living" to flexible "him-based living" was an ongoing, iterative process with setbacks and breakthroughs, occasionally requiring previous breakthroughs to be re-navigated when old parts resurfaced.
2. **Dual Career Practice Integration:** Markus actively practiced as an independent certified coach through Turtle Transformation Ltd. alongside his CTO roles, and is now bringing this integrated coaching mastery back into high-growth corporate executive roles.

5. Key Breakthroughs & Future Outlook (2026 & Beyond)

Key Breakthroughs

- **Personal Agency over Unwritten Rules (2006):**
Recognizing his right to assert contractual boundaries without sacrificing work quality.
- **Emotional Digestion over Shutdown (2014-2026):**
Digesting overwhelming feelings of panic and shock safely via Parts Work (*Key to the Heart* / IFS) rather than disconnecting.
- **Psychological Safety & Operational Excellence (2014–2020):**
Re-framing mistakes as gaps in knowledge or opportunity rather than malicious intent, creating low-stress environments where team performance and retention flourish.
- **"Him-Based Living" & Self-Worth (2021–2026):**
Overcoming the fear of abandoning childhood rules, recognizing that personal and workplace thriving is an individual responsibility.

Future Outlook

As of 2026, Markus stands as a unique executive leader who combines technical data mastery (PhD in Bioinformatics, former Director of Data at Scout24) with deep psychological awareness and formal coaching credentials. Returning to corporate executive leadership, he approaches high-demand environments with low emotional reactivity, clear self-worth, and a flexible vision for his future. His ongoing peer consulting relationship serves as an active sounding board for continuous self-reflection as he navigates executive management, fatherhood, and personal growth.